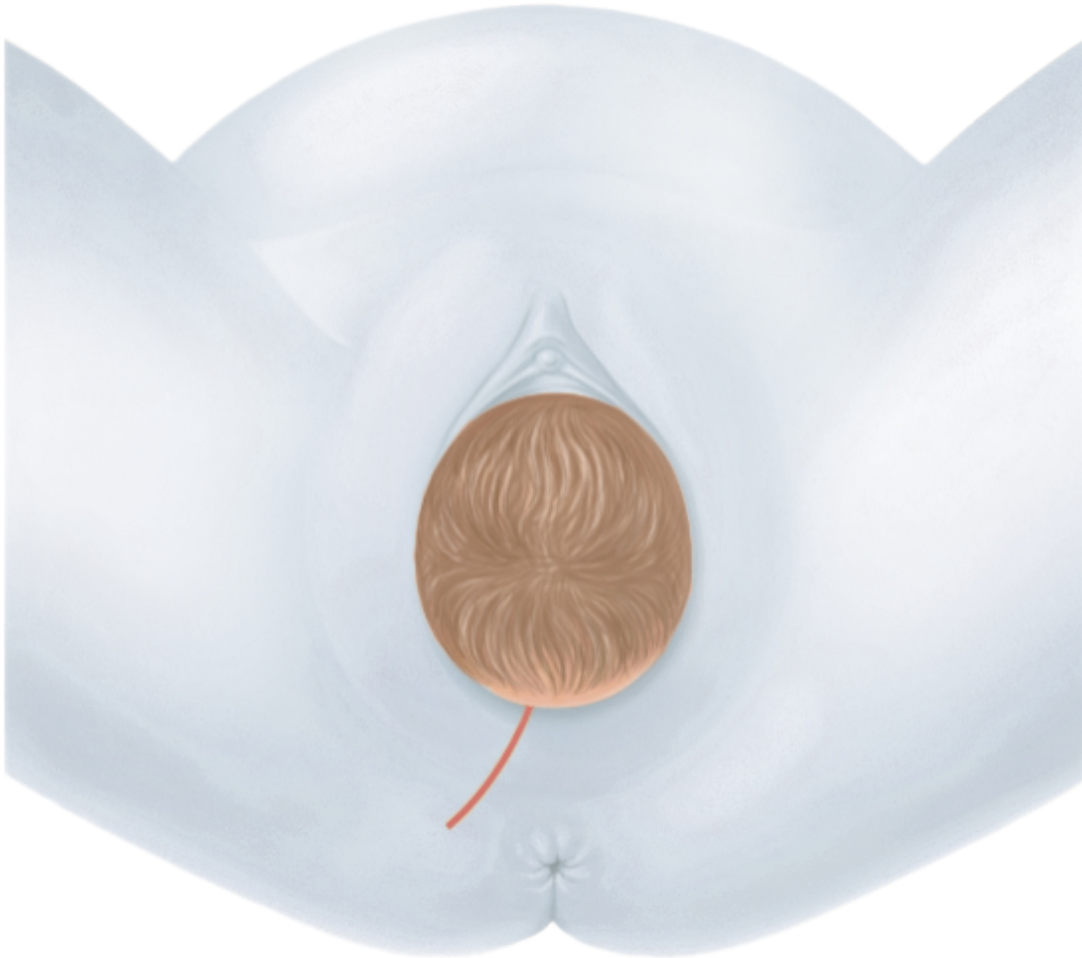


How you may be affected You're more likely to be given an episiotomy cut, particularly during a forceps delivery, to protect your back passage from more severe damage during the birth. This is usually successful, but in some cases a third or, rarely, a fourth-degree tear may occur in the back passage and careful stitching is required to repair the area. Stitches may also be used if you get other tears in or around the vagina.



A medio-lateral cut is usually done into the muscle, angled away from the vagina and the perineum.